

Following in his father's footsteps, he became an orchestral violinist from the age of 14. His first known compositions date from 1816, but success eluded him. He earned a living as an orthopedist in Berlin in the 1830s, and from 1849 ran a glass factory at Sandö in Sweden. In his spare time he wrote a large amount of ambitious music, including symphonies, tone poems, operas, and chamber works. Of his seven symphonies, only the first was performed in his lifetime. He enjoyed a belated success when his opera *Estrella de Soria* was applauded at its premiere in Stockholm in 1862. Two years before his death from pneumonia, he became professor of composition at the Stockholm Conservatory. His posthumous reputation took many years to develop, with most of his works not premiered until the 20th century.

KEY WORKS: Violin Concerto in C-sharp minor, 1820; *Estrella de Soria* (opera), 1841; Symphony No. 3 in C major, "Singulière," 1845; Piano Concerto in D major, 1855

Mikhail Glinka

1804–1857, RUSSIAN

The founder of Russian musical nationalism, Glinka was born into a wealthy family in the Smolensk region. In his youth he took piano lessons from John Field but at first seemed no